The Australian Effie Awards

General Entry Form 2016

Entry Number: 157

Agency The Monkeys

Advertiser Meat & Livestock Australia

Entry Title The Most Successful Lamb Campaign Ever

Category for this Entry Food

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Directions appearing with each question must not to be deleted from the completed case; they serve as a guide for both entrants and judges. Complete entry form in - Type face: black font; 10pt minimum. All data must include a specific, verifiable source. Refer to the Effie "How to Enter" booklet for guidelines on properly sourcing your data. Data without a source will result in entry disqualification. Answer every question or indicate "not applicable" and define your target audience in the entry. Any unanswered question will result in entry disqualification.

Executive Summary (Please Attach the Executive Summary to the front of the entry so the judges can read this first) – An Executive Summary of no more than 100 words is also required (not included in page count).

2015 was a great year for lamb, but 2016 was ridiculous.

'Operation Boomerang' smashed all targets on its way to becoming Meat & Livestock Australia's (MLA) most successful Australia Day Lamb campaign ever.

Combining an insightful strategy with a provocative creative idea and departing from the typical media approach, we generated phenomenal 'earned media' coverage and sent Aussies to butchers – and their BBQs – in droves.

All this, despite a reduced budget, sky-high retail prices, a more competitive marketplace, the World Health Organisation labelling red meat "probably carcinogenic" and Australia Day falling on what has historically been the worst day of the week – a Tuesday.

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1. Total Campaign Expenditure - What was your total expenditure including development, media, production, agency fees and any other costs? Including production and value of donated media and non-traditional paid media.

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2. What was the strategic communications challenge?

What was going on in your category? Provide information on the category, marketplace, company, competitive environment, target audience and/or the product /service that created your challenge and your response to it.

AUSSIES WERE LOSING THEIR APPETITE FOR RED MEAT – Once a red meat lovers' paradise, Australia in recent years has turned down the heat on red meat. We now eat half the quantity of lamb we used to devour in the 1980's, instead favouring white meat such as chicken and pork.

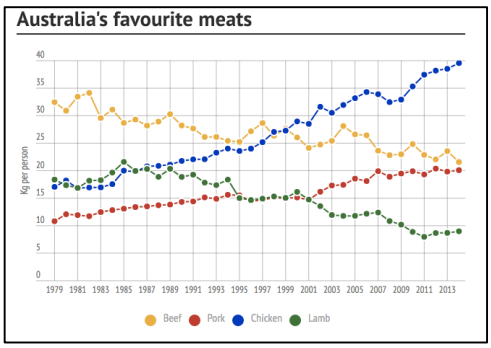


Fig 1. Long-term Meat Consumption Trend in Australia. Source: OECD-FAO, 2015

'WHO' SAYS: "RED MEAT PROBABLY CARCINOGENIC TO HUMANS" – The World Health Organisation (WHO) delivered a curve ball that was definitely unhelpful to the cause of selling Lamb so close to Australia Day. The WHO concluded there were, "positive associations between eating red meat and developing colorectal cancer as well as strong mechanistic evidence". This news enjoyed widespread mainstream coverage and had red meat being compared in some media with smoking.



TUESDAY. A BAD DAY FOR AUSTRALIA DAY – To add to the challenge, Australia Day fell on a Tuesday in 2016. Rather than the convenience of an extended weekend, Australians were expected to enjoy a normal weekend, go back to work on Monday and then celebrate the National Day on Tuesday. Typically, MLA experience a 10% sales uplift when Australia Day falls on a Tuesday, making it their worst performing day of the week for the public holiday.

AN INCREASINGLY EXPENSIVE BBQ – Adding further to the complexity of the task was the ever increasing retail price of lamb. As demand from export markets put upward pressure on domestic prices, climbing from $XX per kg in 2015 to $XX per kg in 2016, lamb had become more expensive than beef, chicken and pork – putting it out of reach for many ordinary Australian dinner tables.

A MARKETING BUDGET THAT WAS STUCK IN REVERSE – While the price of lamb was heading north, the funds available to promote lamb were barely keeping pace with inflation. In fact, our 2016 budget was the lowest in years.

Year	2013	2014	2015	**2016**
Budget	$XX	$XX	$XX	**$XX**

Table 1. MLA Marketing Budgets. Source: MLA, 2013 - 2016

Lamb's share of voice was dwarfed by its closest competitors, Pork and Poultry.

Protein	Poultry	Pork	**Lamb**
SOV	43%	39%	**18%**

Table 2. Fresh Meat Share of Voice. Source: Nielsen Data, 2015 - 2016

THE LEGACY WAS MORE INTIMIDATING THAN THE COMPETITION – MLA has produced successful Australia Day campaigns for Lamb since January 26, 2000. Amongst these are some of the countries most loved, the most successful and the most awarded campaigns in the history of the Effies. The weight of this expectation makes Lamb's Australia Day brief one of the most anticipated and one of the most feared in the country. The pressure was high.

3. What were your objectives? State specific goals

Your entry is expected to include compelling data including behavioural objectives and results. Only in rare instances are the judges likely to award an entry that only demonstrates attitudinal changes. Provide a % or # for all goals. If you do not have a specific type of objective (e.g. no quantifiable objectives), state this in the entry form and explain why and why the objectives you do have are significant and challenging in the context of your category, etc. You must provide benchmark and context for your goals versus year prior and in context of competitive landscape and category.

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE

- Retail sales: +15% uplift (stretch target based on previous campaign benchmarks).

SECONDARY OBJECTIVES

- Media disruption: 1k pieces of 'earned media' coverage (significant as stipulated by One Green Bean PR, a stretch target based on previous campaign benchmarks) representing value over and above media spend.
- Awareness: +10% from pre-campaign (based on Australia Day Millward Brown benchmarks).
- Purchase intent: +5% from pre campaign (based on Australia Day Millward Brown benchmarks).

4. What was your strategy – and how did you get there?

What was your strategy? Was it driven by a consumer insight or channel insight or marketplace / brand opportunity? Explain how it originated and how the strategy addressed the challenge.

BUILDING ON OUR SUCCESS IN 2015…

TOGETHERNESS. WHAT AUSTRALIANS WERE CRAVING – Australians love to enjoy a meal around the table with friends and family. Sadly, this was proving all too rare an event. Research showed that 39% of Australians wished they could eat with others more often and 11% said they had feelings of guilt that they didn't eat together more.[i] It was clear we could help people get together around the table.

BRINGING PEOPLE TOGETHER. A GENUINE ROLE FOR LAMB – Spending time at home with consumers in an ethnographic study, we discovered something genuinely different about the Australian Lamb meal occasion. Unlike chicken, beef and seafood, Lamb was more often than not a shared experience – a meal that brought friends and families together.

This formed the basis of our long-term strategic opportunity – to be Australia's national meat because we bring all Australians together – and marked a change in trajectory for the brand who's only previous point of strategic consistency had been Sam Kekovich.

It was also appealing because it could counter a rising price premium by stressing Lamb's popularity and sharing credentials – the relative cost-per-head going down as more people share a meal.

IDENTIFYING A NEW WAY IN FOR 2016…

A CAMPAIGN FOR ALL AUSTRALIANS – With Richie Benaud's BBQ in 2015, we proved a successful campaign didn't have to test people's 'Australianess' or lambast the nation for being 'unAustralian' if they didn't eat Lamb. We brought Australians together in a more positive and inclusive way. But how many times could we unite a nation around the most epic BBQ in Australia's history? The answer was once.

A NEW INSIGHT – While searching for a fresh approach to 'bring all Australians together', we uncovered an interesting truth that no Australia Day campaign had ever acknowledged - *at any one time, over 1m Aussies are living abroad*[ii]. That's 5% of us. That's a lot for the self-titled 'Lucky Country', blessed with a fantastic climate, golden beaches, cold beers, a laid-back attitude and a fair go for all. The truth is we love it, but we leave it; and then we miss it on Australia Day.

While some people say there's nothing more Australian than an Australian abroad; there's nothing more out of place than an Australian abroad on Australia Day. This was our strategic start point. If we were really going to unite the country and bring all Australians together, we had to bring these Australia Day orphans home.

By doing so, we would not only unite them with friends, family and Australian Lamb, but also tap into a simple human truth – nothing makes us realise how lucky we are, like the thought of missing out. By showing Aussies at home how lucky they were to be able to celebrate in thongs, playing backyard cricket with mates, with a cold beer in their hand and Australian Lamb on the BBQ, we'd drive domestic sales of Lamb.

A NEED FOR DISRUPTION – With the big TV spot broken, or at least out of our budget, we had to break the Internet instead. In other words, in order to create a national conversation, planning made it clear that the creative execution would have to tap into popular culture to provoke a response that couldn't be bought.

5. What was your big idea?

What was the idea that drove your effort? The idea should not be your execution or tagline. State in 25 WORDS OR LESS.

Bring Australia Day orphans back home to share Lamb with their friends and family.

6. How did you bring the idea to life?

Describe and provide rationale for your communications **strategy** that brings the idea to life. Explain how your idea addresses your challenge. Describe the channels selected/why selected? How did your **creative and media strategies** work together? In not more than three A4 pages show sufficient creative examples to enable the judges to understand the campaign. These pages can be additional to the eight A4 page written entry.

INTRODUCING 'OPERATION BOOMERANG'. A RESCUE MISSION – We launched a full-scale rescue mission to bring Australians trapped overseas home for Australia Day. From the cold darkness of Warsaw, to the boardrooms of Tokyo and changing rooms of Twickenham, Aussies of all descriptions were plucked from their desperate 'Lamb-less' situations and returned to enjoy Australia Day at home, with loved ones and Australian Lamb.



CELEBRITY, BUT NOT AS YOU KNOW IT – We called on the services of a wide variety of Australians from all walks of life, from Lee Lin Chin (SBS News) to Mitchell Johnson (recently retired fast bowler) to ensure we connected with all Aussies, no matter their interests. We even reprised Sam Kekovich's role as patriotic Australian and put George Calombaris (of MasterChef fame) in charge of BBQ tongs to ensure no chop was over-cooked.



SEASONED WITH A PINCH OF CONTROVERSY – With limited resources, we knew that earned media would be our best friend. With that in mind, our strategy aimed to provoke a response and get both traditional and social media tongues wagging by adding some spice to our comms. To ensure we had everyone's attention, we attempted to rescue a recent vegan convert, only to set fire to his bowl of kale on discovering his new life choice. This would bring howls of protest from vegans everywhere. Perfect.



A LONG-LENGTH FILM, IDEAL FOR SHARING – We knew we couldn't get the reach we wanted with our reduced budget – so a regular TV buy was out of the question. Instead we backed our judgement and produced a 2-minute film designed for social & digital platforms and ideal for sharing. Or so we hoped. We launched it in digital, social and PR and let the power of a little vegan controversy and the internet do the rest.



7. How do you know your campaign was successful?

Detail why you consider your effort a success. Refer to your objectives (results must relate directly to your objectives in (3) – restate them and provide results) and demonstrate how you met or exceeded those objectives using quantitative and behavioural metrics. Did your effort drive in-market results? Did it drive awareness and consumer behaviour change? Use charts and data whenever possible. Explain what x% means in your category. For confidential information proof of performance may be indexed if desired. Demonstrate the correlation between activity and outcomes. Make sure you address every objective, whether fully achieved or not. Indicate why the results you have are significant in the context of your category, competition and product / service.

PRIMARY OBJECTIVE – *Retail sales: +15% uplift*

- Despite historically poor outcomes when Australia Day fell on a Tuesday (+10%), Lamb retail sales increased
  +37% compared with average weekly retail sales over the previous 52 weeks – an incremental uplift of **$XX**
- This was **almost 2.5 times higher (246%)** than the 15% target set by MLA.
- 'Operation Boomerang' is the most successful Australia Day campaign ever – achieving **over 1.5 times (160%)** the previous record for retail sales uplift, set by the "Lambnesia" campaign in 2013 (which fell on a Saturday).

"This is MLA's most successful Australia Day campaign on record".

Andrew Howie, MLA Group Marketing Manager

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE – *Media disruption: 1k pieces of media coverage*

- The campaign generated **1,310 pieces** of individual coverage both at home and across the world. This was 310 more pieces than our target, or 131% of the target.
- This led to a huge increase in opportunity to see of 531%, even when compared to the hugely popular 2015 Ritchie Benaud campaign.

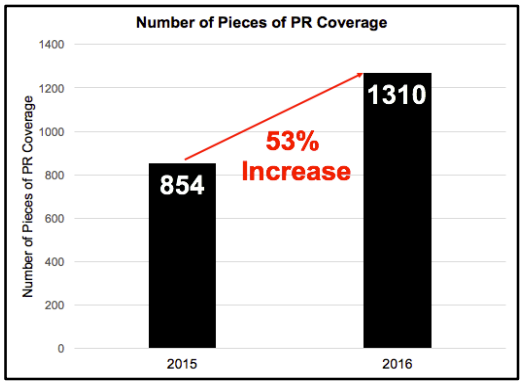


Fig 4. PR Coverage vs 2015 Australia Day campaign benchmark. Source: One Green Bean, 2016

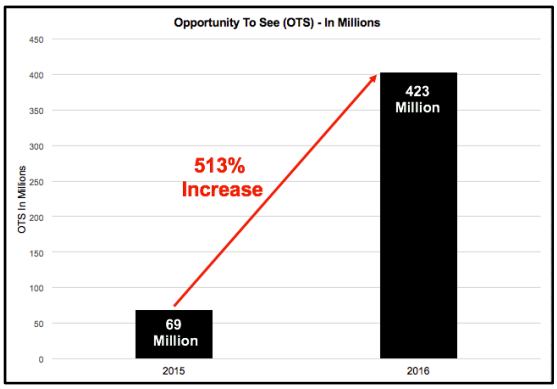


Fig 5. Opportunity to see (OTS) vs 2015 Australia Day campaign benchmark. Source: One Green Bean, 2016

The most talked about Australia Day campaign ever

Millward Brown pre-testing had already told us that our advertising performed **in the top 10% of all ads**[iii] against the statement, 'definitely would send on to others' (Appendix Fig.9), but nobody expected what followed:

- Our digital, social and PR driven strategy led to **5.4 million views**[iv], with our film being **shared 55,000 times**[v], and searched for more than another other Australia Day campaign on record according to Google Trends (Appendix Fig.10). It also **topped YouTube's 'most watched ads' and 'most watched mobile ads'** lists for Q1 in Australia, with Google Australia Head of YouTube and Ads Chris Dodson saying, "The 'We Love Lamb' Australia Day video featuring Lee Lin Chin and Sam Kekovich captured the attention of viewers and, at two minutes long, showed audiences have an attention span for interesting content."[vi]
- 'Operation Boomerang' also became Australia's most complained about ad[vii]. Ever. Despite a modest TV budget, the film resulted in 747 complaints to the Advertising Standards Board. That's more than the controversial Ashley Maddison, 'Have an affair' campaign.



As a result, Operation Boomerang was the **the most efficient Australia Day media campaign ever:** Facebook delivered a Cost Per View (CPV) of just $0.02[viii] – **86% more efficient than the industry benchmark of $0.15.**

- Similarly, YouTube delivered a CPV of just $0.09c[ix] - **40% more efficient than the industry benchmark of $0.15**. Considering this was a 2-minute film, these were exceptionally strong results.[x]
- Engagement rates on Facebook ran at 4% - almost **10 times the industry benchmark**[xi] of 0.37%- including 16,243 shares, 2,700 comments and 22,000 likes.

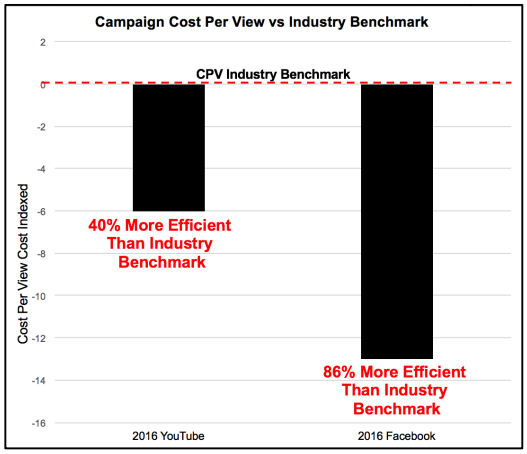


Fig 6: Cost per view vs Industry benchmark: Source: UM, 2016

SECONDARY OBJECTIVE – *Awareness:* +10% from pre-campaign

- In a period notorious for consumer disengagement, we grabbed the attention of consumers and 'comms awareness' for Lamb increased from 17% pre-campaign to 36%[xii] during our campaign, that's **almost double our target (190%)**.
- ''Purchase intent' climbed from 37% to 47%[xiii] during our campaign, **doubling our target.** More importantly, this intent translated into actual sales.

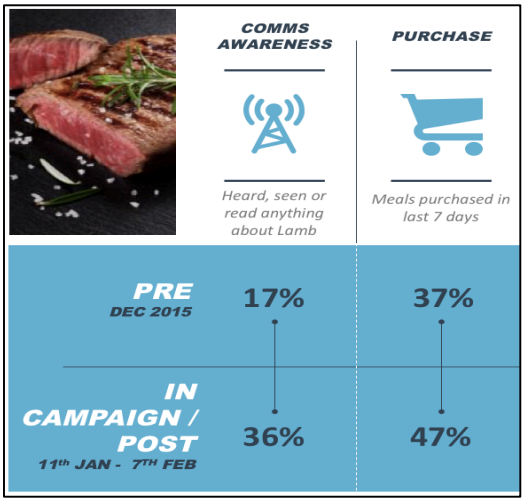


Fig 7: Post Campaign Report Source: Millward Brown, 2016

8. Did it achieve a positive ROI?

You need to convince the judges that the marketing investment provided a positive financial return – if that was a requirement. Indexing of data is acceptable. Your entry will not be ineligible if you don't provide any data, but entries that do provide convincing evidence will gain additional marks. (Note that this data can be excluded from the published case on request.) We recognise that, in some instances, a measurable financial return will not be an objective, but you will need to persuade the judges why not. ROI measures by what percentage the incremental gross profit (not gross sales) generated exceeded the campaign costs/investment. 'Incremental' means comparing what happened, with what would be expected to happen had the campaign not taken place and/or that status quo maintained. So, if the incremental gross profit is $1,000 and campaign costs are $1,000, they cancel each other out and the ROI is 0%. If additional gross profit was $1,500 the ROI is 50%.

MLA'S CHARTER IS TO DRIVE VOLUME DEMAND, NOT PROFIT – MLA delivers research, development and marketing services to Australia's cattle, sheep and goat producers. MLA has approximately 50,000 livestock producer members who have stakeholder entitlements in the company and make markedly varying profit margins. MLA is not an industry body and does not lobby government or regulate the industry. Neither does MLA itself own or sell any cattle, sheep or goat or the products derived from them. MLA's responsibility is to generate volume demand for its members by investing in advertising initiatives. With no responsibility or authority over production, supply chain or setting prices, MLA's marketing can only be judged on its ability to **drive volume demand for farmers**. (Appendix Fig.11).

'FARMER ROI'. THE TRUE MEASURE OF ROI FOR 'OPERATION BOOMERANG' – Given it's not possible for us to provide an ROI based on incremental profit from the best-ever retail sales, we have calculated a 'Farmer ROI' based on ***'incremental volume demand'*** x ***'over-the-hooks price'***. This is the truest measure of ROI because it represents the actual price per kg ('over-the-hooks price') paid directly to the farmer ($XX per kg), not the retail price ($XX per kg).

Volume sold (kg) – 'Operation Boomerang' – 4 week period	XX kg
Volume sold (kg) – av. all other Australia Day campaigns – 4 week period	XX kg
Incremental volume	XX kg
'Over-the-hooks' price per kg – paid direct to farmers	$XX
Gross sales increase (Incremental) for farmers	**$XX**

Table 3. Gross Sales Increase Calculation – 'Operation Boomerang' vs all other Australia Day campaigns

Gross sales increase (Incremental)	**$XX**
Campaign costs	**$XX**
Gross sales increase (Incremental) – campaign costs	**$XX**
'Farmers' return on investment	**2.32 or 232%**

Table 4. 'Operation Boomerang' Farmer ROI

Volume uplift for farmers was the highest of any Australian Day Campaign (Appendix Fig.12). The result was further endorsed by the President of Sheepmeat Council of Australia, Jeff Murray, who said: *"The record boost in lamb sales around Australia Day this year demonstrates that the campaign is a great investment for sheep producers."*

9. Convince us that the result was not due to other factors.

You must explain in your entry the effect of any other potentially relevant factors such as product changes, pricing changes, distribution changes, competitive activity, press coverage, economic conditions, weather etc. You should acknowledge and estimate the role played by other factors and you should advise if the communications program led to other benefits accruing (such as retailers taking on more SKU's, improving space allocated and access to promotional activity, or even improved support from a sales force that has 'increased belief' in the brand). Advertising rarely works in isolation but the judges need to be convinced that your campaign had a major impact on results.

There were no other significant factors that would have led to Lamb's 2016 Australia Day result.

Media Spend: this was the lowest level of investment in years for MLA and lower than key competitors, Pork and Chicken (Appendix Fig. 8).

Distribution: remained stable over the period. Our campaign idea was successful in engaging retailers however, with 78% of them participating in the retail event over the January period[xiv].

Retail Price: the retail price of lamb increased – making it more expensive than beef, pork and chicken. Despite this price increase, the campaign delivered record volume uplifts for farmers (Appendix Fig. 12). Importantly, our 'Farmer ROI' was calculated based on the 'over-the-hooks' price (the price paid directly to the farmer) which had actually decreased versus previous campaigns periods – making it a conservative reflection of what were record sales results.

Product: remained the same high quality standard that Australians have enjoyed for years.

Packaging: there were no new, innovative packaging formats that may have led to an increase.

Natural Australia Day effect: 'Operation Boomerang' was benchmarked against previous Australia Day campaign norms and its record results - over and above those achieved by any previous Australia Day campaign – demonstrating its effectiveness way beyond any 'organic' uplift that might be expected.

10. Do you think there are any lessons to be learned from this case about advertising effectiveness or measurement? Judges will give additional marks to exceptional ideas, exceptional results and to cases that teach us something about how advertising works. A big idea is worth more than a lesser idea. A case that adds to our knowledge about advertising effectiveness or measurement deserves additional marks. These marks are open to the discretion of the judges. This is the "I wish I'd been responsible for that" factor. We Ask judges to reward great ideas, great results, originality, innovative measurement techniques, and penalise poorly written cases. High scores here will be the cases we want marketing students to be inspired by; the cases we can learn something from; the cases we want to showcase to the world.

Learning 1. Evolve the strategy, not just the execution
It's critical to unlock the strategic potential of your brand before jumping to executional solutions. Without evolving the brand strategy, Sam Kekovich, and 'National Pride' would have remained the focus of the Lamb brand and its communications. Our strategic evolution placed 'Togetherness' at the heart of the brand, and is a key reason why 'Operation Boomerang' was so effective.

Learning 2. You can't buy cultural relevance, but you can plan for it
Finding a cultural reference point can be a really effective way to generate earned media value and drive cultural cachet. Importantly, it doesn't always need to please everyone. Intending to provoke a response from the cultural sensitivity around veganism helped boost our success – delivering value that paid media can't.

Learning 3. The 'big idea' is not dead
The death of the big idea has been a recurring topic in marketing and advertising circles[xv]. 'Operation Boomerang' is proof that the 'big idea' is alive and kicking – and even more important in today's hyper-connected world.

Learning 4. Entertainment is everything
Researchers have proven that people now have a shorter attention span than Goldfish[xvi] - highlighting the need for ideas that entertain and engage. 'Operation Boomerang' was over 2 minutes in length and was the most watched ad on YouTube for Q1[xvii]. Stop worrying about the length of your message, start with the ambition of making it as entertaining as possible.

Learning 5. A brave client can be the difference between good work and great work
As an industry, we don't give enough kudos to the bravery of our clients. Without the support, encouragement and ambition of our MLA client, this campaign would not have been possible.

Learning 6. Agencies must work together to deliver great results
This campaign proves that creative agencies must work as a team with their media and PR partners to achieve an outstanding result. Too often, creative agencies get too precious and aren't open to thinking that's born outside their walls. This was a genuine case of collaboration between creative, media and PR – all striving to make the idea the best it could be.

Learning 7. Vegans don't have a sense of humour*.

*Just kidding

APPENDIX

- Challenging SOV, even in January:

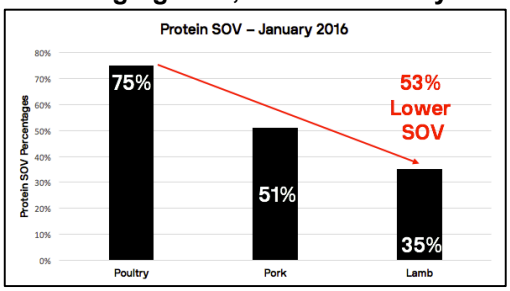


Fig 8: TV SOV vs key competitors: Jan 2016. Source: Nielson

- Distinctive, well branded and worth sharing:

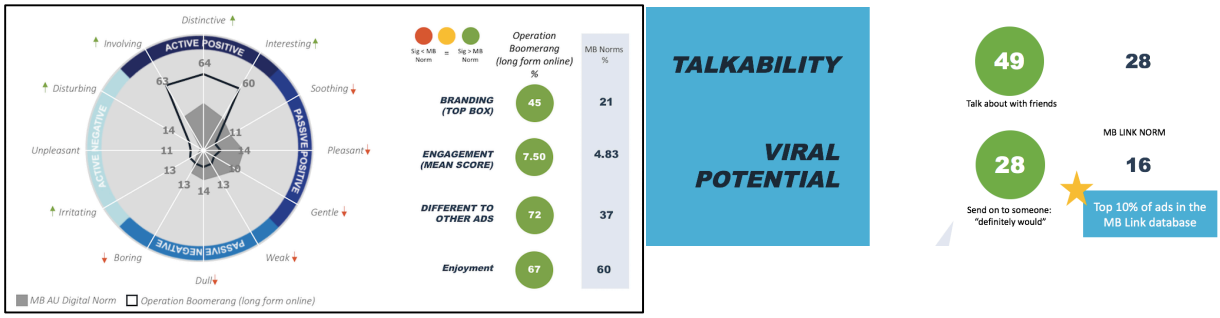


Fig 9. Post Campaign Report Source: Millward Brown, 2016

- Google Searches for "Australia Day Lamb" vs previous campaigns

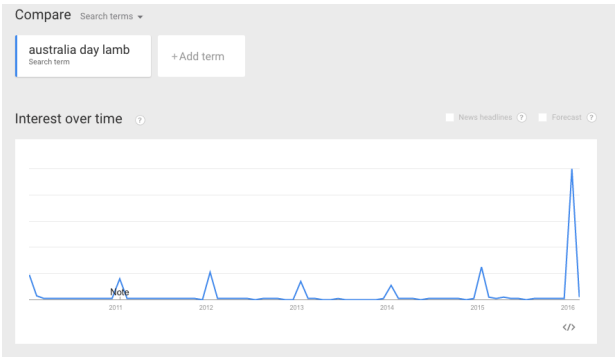


Fig 10. Google Trends vs Prior Australia Day Campaigns

- Breaking down MLA's responsibility

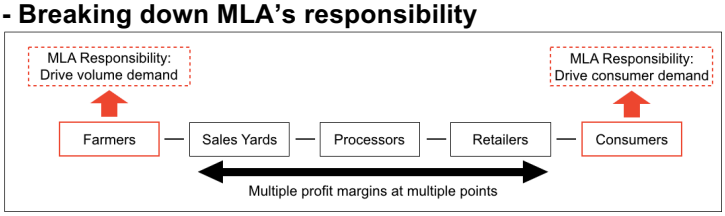


Fig 11. Simplified Supply Chain, MLA/LAMB. Source: MLA, 2016

- Best Ever Volume Uplift for Farmers

i IKEA Life at Home Report, July 2015
ii DFAT Submission No 646 to the Senate Inquiry into Australian Expatriates, 2004
iii Millward Brown Pre-Testing, 2015/2016
iv Facebook and YouTube In-Page Analytics, 2016
v Facebook and YouTube, In-Page Analytics, 2016
vi YouTube results published in AdNews, April 27, 2016
vii Advertising Standards Board, 2016
viii UM, Media Post Campaign Report, 2016
ix UM, Media Post Campaign Report, 2016
x UM, Media Post Campaign Report, 2016
xi Quintly, Social Media Benchmarking Study, 2016
xii Millward Brown, March 2016
xiii Millward Brown, March 2016
xiv Millward Brown, March 2016
xv Brand Report Blog, "The death of the big idea", APG, 2014
xvi Time Magazine, 2015. "You now have a shorter attention span than a Goldfish"
xvii YouTube Most Viewed Videos in Australia, Q1, 2016

AGENCY AND ADVERTISER AUTHORISATION

SIGNATURE FOR ENTRY BY COMPANY OFFICERS

We certify on behalf of:

Mark Green (Agency CEO) and A. Howie (Client Company CEO or equivalent)

that the information submitted for the attached campaign is a true and accurate portrayal of the objectives and results of that campaign.

We also certify that the campaign has not been found in breach of any advertising or marketing codes or in breach of any law within the Australian jurisdiction.

We acknowledge that the case study of this campaign may be published by The Communications Council or with the authorisation of The Communications Council, but that we will have the opportunity to remove such information from that case study that we regard as market sensitive or confidential.

Signature of Officer of Agency

Title:
Company:
Date:

Signature of Officer of Client Company

Title: Group Marketing Manager
Company: MLA
Date: 26.4.16